6.11 Intestinal Obstruction*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My abdomen is swollen and I cannot pass wind." • Colicky pain 7/10 **Objective** • Distended abdomen • Vomiting • High-pitched bowel sounds	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to bowel distension as evidenced by colicky pain and distension.	• Pain and distension reduced within 24 hours.	• Nil by mouth. • Pass an NG tube for decompression as ordered and chart the drainage. • Give analgesia as prescribed. • Measure abdominal girth every 4–8 hours.	• Considered met as pain and girth decrease.
Subjective • "I keep vomiting." **Objective** • Dry mouth • Low urine output • Low potassium	**ACTUAL** Inadequate fluid volume related to vomiting and fluid sequestration in the bowel as evidenced by dry mucosa and low urine output.	• Adequate urine output and normal electrolytes within 24 hours.	• Give IV fluids and potassium as prescribed. • Keep an intake and output chart that includes NG losses. • Follow electrolytes.	• Goal reached when fluid balance is restored.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Complete bowel obstruction • HR rising	**RISK** Risk for shock as evidenced by risk factors: strangulation, bowel ischemia and fluid loss.	• Any sign of strangulation is detected early.	• Report constant pain, fever, a rising HR or peritonism. • Prepare for surgery as ordered.	• Met if shock does not develop.

*References for this care plan: [32], [35], [37], [64]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.